

FINANCE POLICY

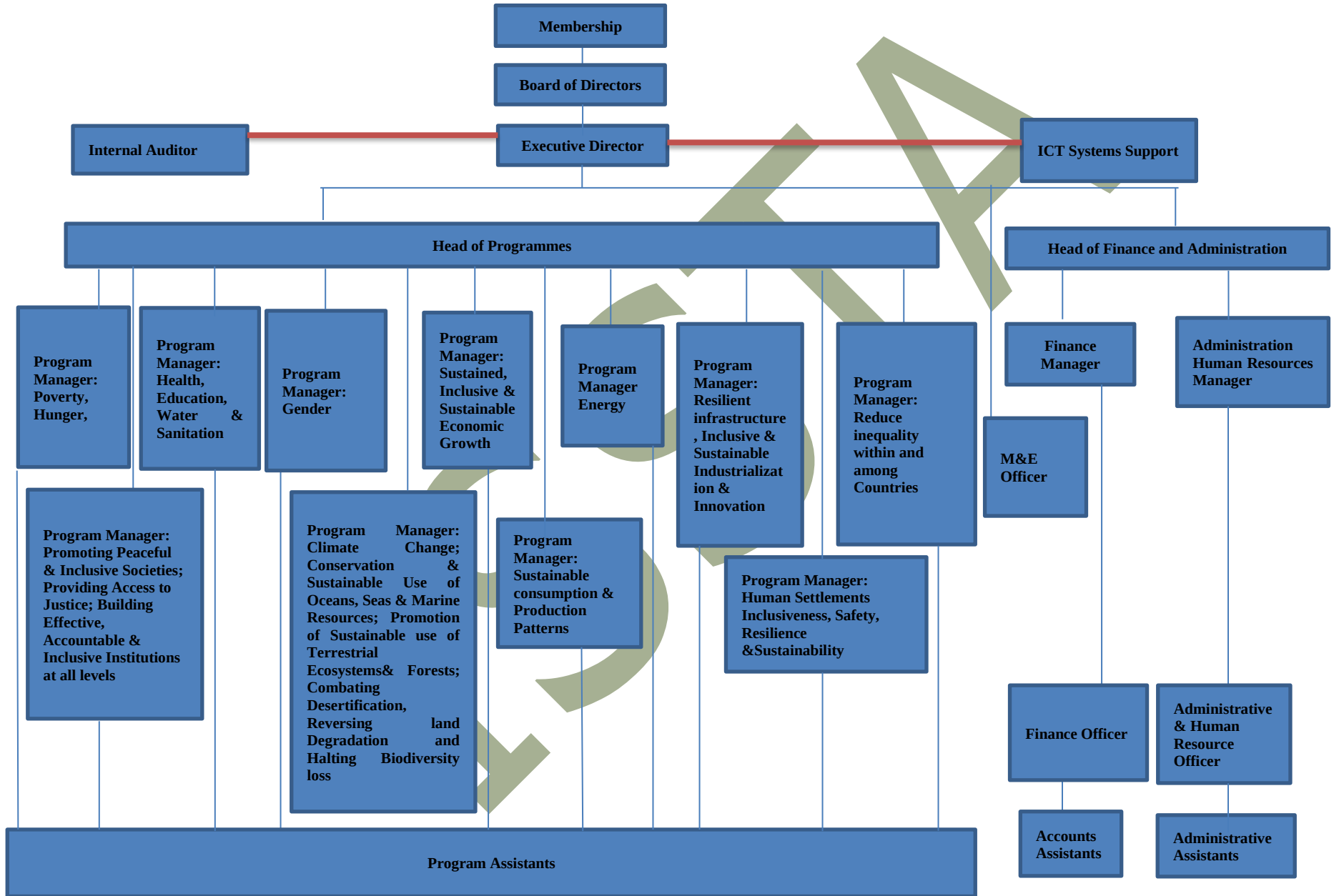
INSTITUTE FOR SUSTAINABLE SOCIOECONOMIC TRANSFORMATION OF AFRICA (ISSTA)



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ISSTA Organogram



ISSSTA

ISSUA

TABLE OF CONTENTS

No.	Particulars	Page
	ORGANOGRAM OF ISSTA	i
	TABLE OF CONTENTS	ii
	LIST OF ACRONYMS	iii
	ISSTA GOAL, VISION, MISSION, AND VALUES	iv
1.0	INTRODUCTION	5
1.1	Purpose, Objective and Scope of Manual	5
1.2	Review and Amendments	5
1.3	Users of the Manual	5
1.4	Accounting Software	6
2.0	FINANCIAL AND MANAGEMENT PROCEDURES	6
2.1	Accounting Convention	6
2.2	Accounting Convention	6
2.3	Capital Expenditure	6
2.4	Duration of ISSTA Financial Year	7
2.5	Financial Reports	7
3.0	PROCEDURES FOR INITIATING, AUTHORIZING AND APPROVING TRANSACTIONS	8
4.0	SAFEGUARDING CASH/FUNDS	13
4.1	Handling cash	13
4.2	Chart of Accounts	14
5.0	ACCOUNTING DOCUMENTS	14
5.1	Cheque Payment Voucher	15
5.2	5.2 Petty cash payment voucher	15
5.3	Journal Voucher	15
5.4	Local Purchase Order (LPO)	15
5.5	Goods Received Note (GRN)	15
5.6	Advance Retirement Form	15
5.7	Cash Acknowledgement Form	15
5.8	Receipt	16
5.9	Cash Count Form	16
6.0	ACCOUNTING REGISTERS	16
6.1	Cash Book	16
6.2	Cheques Register	16
6.3	Creditors Register	16
6.4	Fixed Assists Register	16
7.0	SALARY ADVANCES	17
7.1	Procedure for Salary Advance	17
7.2	Advances for Programme Implementation	17
7.3	Procedures for Accounting for Staff Imprest	18
8.0	BANKING	18
9.0	ACCOUNTING RECORDS	21
9.1	Cash Book	21
9.2	Receipt Book	21
9.3	Payment Voucher	22
9.4	Accountability Form	22
10.0	DEBTORS	22
11.0	CREDITORS	22
12.0	PERSONNEL COSTS	22
12.1	Payroll procedures	22
12.2	Statutory deductions	23
12.3	Telephone Costs	23
13.0	STOCKS AND STORES	23

TABLE OF CONTENTS

No.	Particulars	Page
13.1	Good Received Note (GRN)	24
13.2	Material Returns Note (MRN)	24
13.3	Stock counting	24
14.0	QUOTATIONS	24
15.0	LOCAL PURCHASE ORDER	25
16.0	SUPPLY OF GOODS	25
17.0	SUPPLY OF SERVICES	25
18.0	PAYMENT FOR GOODS AND SERVICES	25
19.0	CONFLICT OF INTEREST	26
20.0	USE OF ASSETS	26
20.1	Motorcycles	26
20.2	Vehicles and Insurance	26
20.3	Custody of Assets	27
20.4	Asset Loss or Damage	27
21.0	STAFF IDENTITY CARDS	28
22.0	PER DIEMS	28
22.1	BoDs SITTING ALLOWANCE	28
22.2	BoD monitoring visits and other duties	28
22.3	Out of Pocket	28
22.4	Accommodation	29
22.5	Transport Costs	29
22.6	Honorarium	29
23.0	FINANCIAL AUDIT	29
24.0	DISCLAIMER	29
25.0	ANNEXES OF TEMPLATES	29

LIST OF ACRONYMS

AGM	Annual General Meeting
AIF	Advance Imprest Form
BoDs	Board of Directors
CPAU	Chartered Institute of Public Accountants of Uganda
ED	Executive Director
FC	Finance Committee of the Board of Directors
FM	Finance Manager
GA	General Assembly
GRN	Goods Received Note
HFA	Head, Finance, and Administration
HoPs	Head of Programmes
HRAM	Human Resources and Administration Manager
IA	Internal Auditor
IFRS	International Financial Regulatory Standards
IGF	Internally Generated Funds
ISSTA	Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa
LPO	Local Purchase Order
MEAL	Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning
M&EP	Monitoring and Evaluation Personnel
MRN	Material Returns Note
NGOs	Non-Governmental Organizations
NSSF	National Social Security Fund
PA	Programme Assistant
PAYE	Pay as You Earn
PM	Programmes Manager
PO	Programme Officer
SP	Strategic Plan

ISSTA VISION, MISSION, VALUES, TARGET GROUPS, AND OBJECTIVES

ISSTA Vision

A world prospering in Sustainable Development, poised to cater for present and future generations

ISSTA Mission

Contributing to Sustainable Development of Africa through local, regional, continental and global frameworks

ISSTA Values

ISSTA embraces the values of Team Work, Solidarity, Results Achievement, Accountability, Value for Money, Not Leaving Anyone Behind, Do no Harm, Respect for all Persons, and Shared Responsibility

ISSTA Target Groups

Development stakeholders ranging from ordinary citizens (primary beneficiaries'/rights holders), local and central government (duty bearers), regional and international development agencies (partners)

ISSTA Key Objective

To support localization of sustainable development in selected locations of Uganda and Africa

ISSTA Specific Objectives

- (i) To build economically feasible non-partisan grassroots structures working towards food and nutrition security and market competitiveness
- (ii) To mainstream women, girls, youth, climate justice, health justice, PWDs, men, and deprived persons issues into activities of grassroots socioeconomic structures
- (iii) To build grass roots civic engagement capacities within grassroots structures and local civil society towards quality service provision by duty bearers, human rights observance, democracy and accountability

1.0 INTRODUCTION

1.1 Purpose, Objective and Scope of Manual

The manual provides a documented guide towards prudent management of ISSSTA resources. FP aims at giving clear and concise guidance on safe custody and prudent management of the organization's financial operations and programme implementation. Approaches and procedures herein are subject to amendment given a changing contemporary context of the real world scenario, there should occur regular updates. All staff, ISSSTA managers and BoD, support services/suppliers, etc. are bound by stipulations herein while financially dealing with ISSSTA. Staffs need to ensure compliance given that the survival of ISSSTA oscillates a lot on financial prudence and the image ISSSTA will portray to partners as accountable, transparent, and credible. Such an image will largely be built by outcomes of external audits, term reviews, observance of ISSSTA commitments as stipulated in MoUs with funders, suppliers, etc. Oversight of FP will be provided by the Finance Committee (FC) of the BoDs while direct implementation is the responsibility of the Finance and Administration Director, supervised by the ED. Auditing and associated reports will be supplied by an external auditor.

1.2 Review and Amendments

The FAD will originate the necessary catalogue for proposed amendments that will be in line with achieving enhanced financial efficiency and programme implementation. The catalogue will be channeled through the ED to the FC which will approve the amendments with or with adjustments. After this, the catalogue of amendments will become an official component of the FP. Components of the catalogue can be contributed to by staff during staff meetings, individually via a one-on-one with the FAM. Through FAM initiation, a request for innovative ideas for a review process can be floated and synthesized by FAM to output a final precise catalogue of proposed amendments.

1.3 Users of the Manual

This manual is intended for use by the ED during execution of as Chief Accounting Officer of the organization, he authorizes payments as stipulated on the SP work plan for the current period. The FAD will refer to the FP as the direct administrator while the rest of the staff will comply with the FP stipulations as they procure and utilize financial and physical resources of ISSSTA. The manual may also be referred to by term evaluators, external auditors, and

management consultants. The official authorized hard and e-version of the manual will be in the custody of the ED and the FAM. Otherwise the rest of the staff and FC members will possess copies.

1.4 Accounting Software

ISSTA is flexible but cautious towards the use of manual and or electronic accounting packages. In other words, it is open to adopting enhanced efficiency accounting systems particularly in the direction of E-Systems like quick books and others that the external auditor will recommend.

2.0 FINANCIAL AND MANAGEMENT PROCEDURES

2.1 Accounting Convention

The Organization will prepare accounts under the International Generally Accepted Accounting Principles basing on the historical cost convention. Day to day transactions will be recorded at the monetary value of the transaction in Uganda shillings, here in abbreviated as UGX. ISSTA shall use the cash basis of accounting while paying attention to double entry book keeping and using electronic or hard copy journals.

2.2 Recognition of Receipts and Expenditures

Receipts comprise of grants, donations in kind or Internally Generated Funds (IGF) and will be registered as income on ISSTA income and expenditure statements. Donations in kind will be converted into Uganda shillings according to the going market rates. Expenditures will comprise programme costs, and administrative expenditures. All expenditure shall be recognized and recorded at the time of payment and not when services are rendered or goods supplied. Otherwise, when a supply happens, it will be recorded as a payable in the accounts payable register and in the same vein, when payments fall due to ISSTA, they will be recorded as receivables in the account receivable register. Where funds are advanced for a particular activity, expenditure shall be recognized when money is paid out and balanced off when the accountability is submitted. Accountability should be submitted to HFAs office within a fortnight after return to the duty station, without which, the staff remains a debtor to the organization.

2.3 Capital Expenditure

All purchases of capital items shall be expended upon payment. Therefore, no fixed asset accounts shall be maintained by ISSTA. However, the ISSTA shall maintain fixed asset register of capital items, which shall be updated whenever purchases and disposals are made.

Each asset category shall have its listing as below:

- (i) Land
- (ii) Plants
- (iii) Buildings
- (iv) Vehicle including bicycles, motor cycles, tractors, and automobiles
- (v) Computer & Computer Accessories
- (vi) Office Equipment
- (vii) Furniture and Fittings

2.3.1 Fixed Assets Register

Fixed assets register shall show the following:

- (i) Name and or country of manufacture
- (ii) Serial number, Chassis number and year of manufacture
- (iii) Date purchased and purchase value
- (iv) Insurance policy details
- (v) Funding Agency
- (vi) Location of Asset
- (vii) Current Value and Successive depreciated value per year

The above is basic content and the list can be enhanced with revisions and amendments from time to time particularly at external auditors' advice.

2.4 Duration of ISST Financial Year

ISSTA financial year shall run from 1st January to 31st December

2.5 Financial Reports

HFA will be responsible for the generation of accurate financial reports informative of income, expenditure and accountabilities for management, funder, and statutory needs. Overseen by the HFA, FM should supervise the procurement and management of petty cash (PC) should be secured in a safe and cash box with the cash box kept in the safe to meet expenses not

exceeding Ushs10 Million. FM should ensure that petty cash is balancing on a daily basis without fail and that any imbalances are ironed out with the petty cash manager who will be the accountant. Monies received cannot be transformed into petty cash and must be banked on the date received. The cash book and the petty cash must be balancing on a daily basis.

FM should ensure effective monthly reconciliation of bank statements with all entries on bank statements verified through a perfect match with internal entries and any differences immediately addressed and brought to the knowledge of the HFA, for onward resolve, when necessary, with involvement of the ED, who is the chief accounting officer. FM must ensure that previous month bank reconciliations are ready for perusal by the HFA by the 15th of every month. Overseen by the HFA, FM is also responsible for ensuring budget discipline so that deviations from the SP budget are minimized as much as possible.

3.0 PROCEDURES FOR INITIATING, AUTHORIZING AND APPROVING TRANSACTIONS

Transactions will originate from the various ISSTA departments and based on slated activities as per the approved work plans but consonant with the SP work plan, and budget. Overseen by the HFA, Head of the departments will compile a one-page concept and budget which will be directed to the office of the FM. FM will verify the validity and possibility of the requisition and give the initial authorization. The approved requisition will then be directed to the HFA who will approve or reject the expenditure or request amendments for onward scrutiny and endorsement by the ED. However, once approved, HFA will instruct his department to raise a voucher, attach it to the requisition and summon the implementing officer to sign against receipt of funds. Such approval system will be employed for all expenses approvals. For instance, FM may require cleaning materials. In the same way, the relevant support officer will list down the required materials and attach a voucher for the approval process which starts with the FM as above.

In the case of petty cash approvals, the ED and HFA agree on acceptable expenses for the petty cash provision with the FM closely checking for compliance at the end of every daily close of business, including the verification of cash book transactions and balances. Margins of deviation are not acceptable and population of the register and balancing on a daily basis is compulsory.

Normal practice is that the ED authorizes cheques/payments of up to Ushs50,000,000 as principal signatory with the HoP and for expenses beyond Ushs 51,000,000 onward, the ED authorizes the cheques/payments with the Chairperson BoDs. Transactions with suppliers is articulated by the ISSTA procurement policy. But by and large the procurement process articulates the sourcing of suppliers through advertising and compilation of a prequalification list for regular goods and services required such as fuel, catering, car service and maintenance, etc. Suppliers to ISSTA will operate under contractual stipulations which normally includes presentation invoices for payment at the agreed time following delivery of quality services. Invoices will be presented to the office of the HFA who will process the payment in consultation with relevant programme or administration staff with direct verification responsibility of the services provided.

3.1 Responsibility for Producing Cheques

The Accounts Assistant (AA) is responsible for collecting the cheque book from the *FM office safe* or the *petty cash safe* and writing the cheques by hand or electronically depending on the established ISSTA system of the day. After which AA follows up the processing, including authorization by both signatories to the account and when complete, contact the requisitioner to pick up payment against endorsement in a cheque received register or and signing against a voucher on the requisition.

3.2 Check list for cheque verification

A checklist is provided below, for reference to guide signatories while endorsing ISSTA cheques and is useful for validity so that payments are not bounced by banks since it damages the reputation of ISSTA. However, it could also prevent a devastating fraud.

See checklist below:

- (i) Compliance with procurement policy stipulations
- (ii) Compliance with finance and administration policy stipulations
- (iii) Compliance with human resources policy stipulations
- (iv) Adequacy of supporting documentation
- (v) Funds sufficiency
- (vi) Coherence between the amount in words and the amount in figures
- (vii) Existence of appropriate authorizations on all paper work by Managers in case of the ED and in case of the Chairperson BoDs authorizations of the line Managers and the ED should appear on the vouchers and the ED signature should also appear on the cheque

(viii) Note that this list is open to additions as deemed necessary

3.3 Accountability

Accountabilities should be turned in to the AA within a fortnight of return from the field and within 2 days for administrative/support staff involved in purchases. Accountability approval forms should be available at AAs office. The form should be filled by the officer handing in the accountability including the ED and BoDs and verified by the AA. This has nothing to do with the chain of command but rather working together as a team to uphold ISSTA credibility. An outgoing Cheques Register (CR) should be kept with AA for outgoing cheques picked by or delivered to payees who should sign against their relevant row. Cheques can be picked by representatives of payees.

By and large, the register will provide the following details:

- (i) Date
- (ii) Name and signatures of the signatories
- (iii) Brief subject of payment
- (iv) Amount on cheque
- (v) Name and signature of the person issuing the cheque
- (vi) Name of Payee
- (vii) Name, contact, and signature of person picking the cheque
- (viii) Cheque Number and bank

3.4 Cash Book/Register Entries pertaining to issued cheques

The shall include but not limited to:

- (i) Date
- (ii) Purpose of the cheque
- (iii) Voucher number
- (iv) Precise and meaningful description of transaction
- (v) Payee
- (vi) Amount issued and cheque number
- (vii) Proper cost codes including T-analysis codes

Note that invoices and all other supporting documents relating to that payment must be

stamped "RECEIVED" once received and then "PAID" once the cheque has been made, a receipt for payment demanded and received, and filed together.

ISSUE

FIGURE 3: BASIC PAYMENT PROCESS

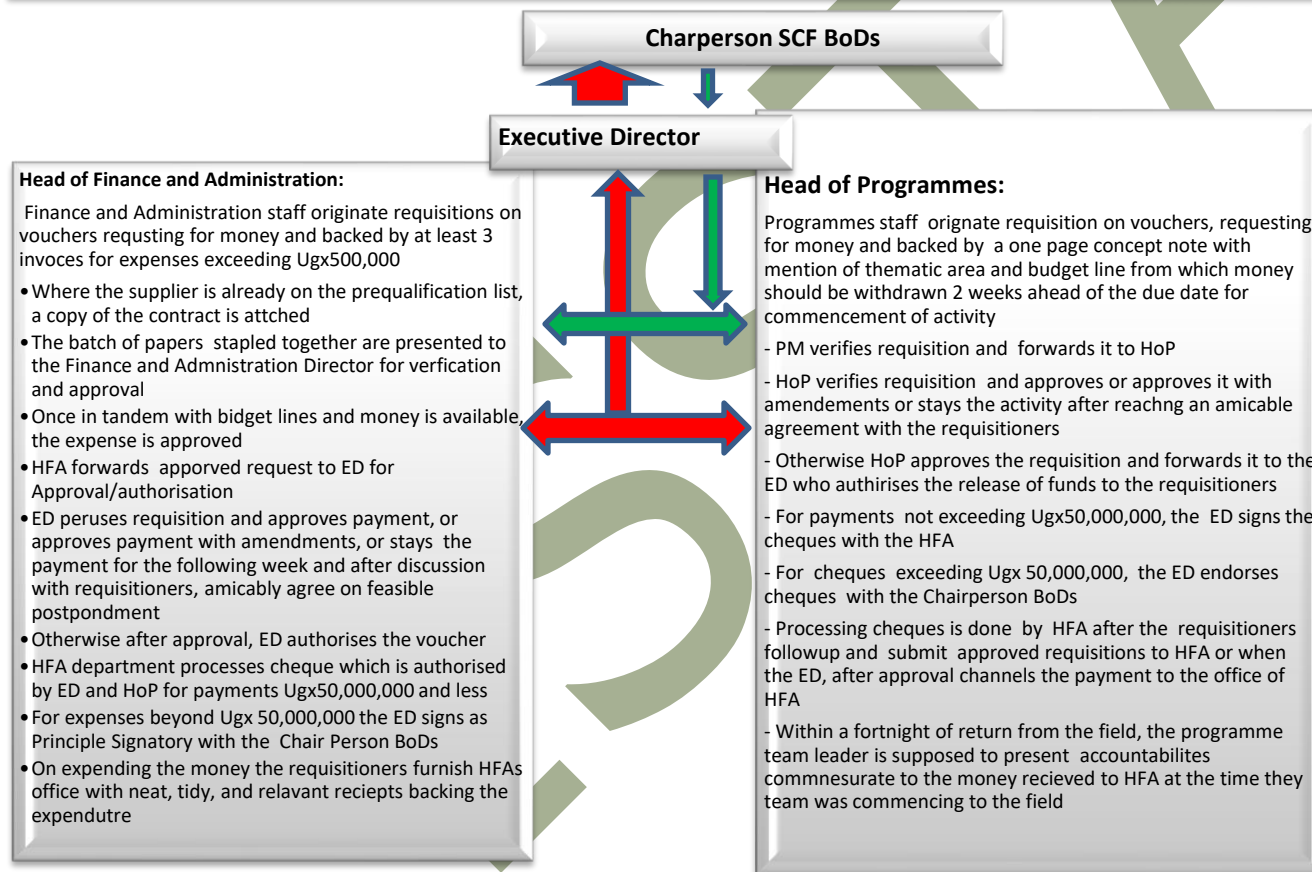


Figure 3 above demonstrates the process for requisition, receipt of money, and accountability by the two departmental flows in service of ISSTA.

Key

Red	Arrows show requisition
Green	Arrows show approval and money moving to the departments for programme implementation and administrative action

3.5 Petty Cash Payments

The cash will be held at Ushs10,000,000 but the AA is limited to expenses not exceeding Ugx 500.000 for a single transaction. Also, FM is responsible for oversight over the daily balancing of the cash transactions against physical cash. The AA will operate on an approved list of expenditure developed by the FM and approved by the HFA. Also, any single petty cash transaction exceeding Ushx500.000 must go through an approval process beginning with the AA, FM/PM, HFA/HoP, to the ED. Once approved by endorsement on the requisition, expenditure can be made. AA should ensure that vouchers and support documentation are all in order and bear all necessary endorsements. Petty cash transactions should be entered accurately into the cash register and or electronics journal (i.e., quick books) that is in current use.

3.6 Other Procedural Assertions

- (i) Payments from petty cash must be made against a duly authorized payment voucher
- (ii) The Accounts Assistant is **NOT ALLOWED** to borrow or lend money from petty cash reserve
- (iii) The payee must sign on the voucher in a designated provision acknowledging receipt of cash
- (iv) Other monies in the safe should be clearly recorded in the petty cash journal as an inflow and as an outflow when banked. Otherwise, non-petty cash monies should be banked immediately
- (v) Petty Cash replenishment should be made once the petty cash float level reaches a minimum level (UgX500,000). This replenishment should be for that amount needed to restore the level of petty cash to the imprest level.
- (vi) Prior to the replenishment, the petty cash book should be fully updated and with the oversight of HFA, FM should ensure that book and cash balances are in agreement.

This should not be difficult if a balancing of books is kept to a daily basis by FM and AA.

- (vii) HFA should ensure that the necessary official stationery with an ISSTA logo (i.e., cheque books, promissory notes, vouchers, LPOs, receipt books etc.) is always available and depending on flow of work and time lag between stationary order and supply be able to ensure that stocks do not run out
- (viii) Custodian of all financial stationary will be the office of the HFA
- (ix) One receipt book should be issued at a time with the officer receiving the stationary signing a stationary register at the office of the HFA
- (x) Incoming cash i.e. membership fees, other fees and dues, disposal of assets, and local fundraising money will be received by the AA against which AA will issue an official receipt
- (xi) As mentioned above, all non-petty cash money should be entered into the cash book and recorded out as soon as banking is done with banking evidenced by the relevant bank deposit slips which should be filed in the office of the HFA. Banking of such monies on ISSTA bank accounts should be done immediately
- (xii) On issuing ISSTA receipts, the original copy of the receipt should be given to the payer, while the duplicate copy can be attached as supporting documentation to the invoice or contract or remain in the receipt book – whichever is workable to the department and also depending on the advice of the external auditor
- (xiii) The AA should sign the receipt before it is issued to the payer
- (xiv) A unique receipt book should also be maintained for cheques received and a receipt clearly indicating the cheque number and bank issued to the payer

4.0 SAFEGUARDING CASH/FUNDS

It is important that the following procedures are strictly complied with in order to safe guard organizations funds as well as the employees

4.1 Handling cash

- (i) Petty cash must be held in hand for the shortest feasible time before utilization
- (ii) Petty Cash and all official monies should be held in the office-safe with up to Ugx 500,000 held in the cash box, which cash box is kept in the HFA departmental safe overnight

- (iii) The safe and cash box must be kept under lock and key at all times
- (iv) Traveling the field with large sums of money is not advisable while the use of electronic systems is encouraged since such systems have global coverage
- (v) Staff and BoDs holding ISSTA money overnight should utilize the office safe for custody if practicable. However, in case monies are lost, the amount will be considered as a debt payable by the person concerned
- (vi) Faced with a robbery the person concerned should safe-guard life first and not act to fight the robber
- (vii) In the event of robbery, the person concerned should immediately procure documentary backing of the incident from police and local authorities and thereafter notify the HFA and the ED

4.2 Chart of Accounts

- (i) The HFA shall ensure that the chart of accounts is designed such that the accounting system is able to provide information required for management's decision making towards effective planning, organizing, delegating, directing, and controlling the affairs of ISSTA
- (ii) In the chart of accounts, the budget lines should be arranged in a logical and flow that is concomitant to SP thematic flow, as reflected in the work plan and the MEAL
- (iii) As an ongoing concern, it is recommended that ISSTA should adopt a high digit number for each account line so as to allow for new accounts to be added as the organization grows. With more digits, new accounts can be added while maintaining the logical or thematic order
- (iv) Additions and alterations to the system should only be made by trained personnel for the purpose
- (v) The ISSTA template for the chart of account will be recommended by the external auditor

5.0 ACCOUNTING DOCUMENTS

Any document that provides information about a business transaction is called a Basic Business Document or a Source Document. They are the starting point for the flow of information through the accounting system into financial statements.

Since the transactions are of various types, source documents are also prepared to record facts and figures, of the peculiarity of the transactions. The accounting documents to be used by ISSTA shall include but not limited to:

5.1 Cheque Payment Voucher

For all payments involving the Bank, a cheque payments voucher shall be raised by AA who will be responsible for entering the budget line for the source of funds

5.2 Petty cash payment voucher

For small cash payments, a petty cash voucher shall be raised by the AA and shall also have a provision for entering the budget line for the source of funds

5.3 Journal Voucher

Journal vouchers shall be used for transactions that do not involve direct payments or receipts but are meant to update accounting records. Such transactions involve correcting errors and adjusting bank charges

5.4 Local Purchase Order (LPO)

LPO shall be used to order for goods required by ISSTA, normally printed in triplicate. The original copy is sent to the supplier, the duplicate shall be used to process payments and the triplicate remains on file

5.5 Goods Received Note (GRN)

Once an LPO has been prepared and dispatched to the supplier, the supplier delivers the consignment accompanied by a delivery note. Goods Received Notes shall be used to acknowledge receipt of goods from suppliers. No payment shall be made to any supplier of goods or services without an ISSTA

5.6 Advance Retirement Form

Advance retirement forms shall be used to account for money advanced to programme staff proceeding to carry out an activity

5.7 Cash Acknowledgement Form

A cash acknowledgement form shall be used as evidence for payments where the recipients

cannot provide proper receipts. The document shall be filled by the official making payment and signed by the recipient

5.8 Receipt

A receipt shall be raised as an acknowledgement of funds received. The original copy shall be given to the payer and the duplicate kept on file in the account's office.

5.9 Cash Count Form

It will be used to verify actual balances of cash at hand. AA will utilize this form and keep it on record for cash on hand and tender it in for balancing checks by the FAM daily as well as for new petty cash requisition or replenishing

6.0 ACCOUNTING REGISTERS

6.1 Cash Book

ISSTA shall maintain a manual cashbook to record both cash and cheque transactions prior and after computerization. It is the responsibility of the HFA, PM, and AA to ensure that cashbooks are always up to date and reconciliation done monthly

6.2 Cheques Register

The accountant shall ensure that a cheque register to record all cheque payments are in place. The register shall have the following columns: Date, Cheque number, payee, amount and signature of the recipient. The Executive Director shall ensure through the HFA that the register is in order, on a monthly basis.

6.3 Creditors Register

For whenever goods are supplied on credit, AA shall enter the supplier's details in the creditor's register. AA will update the register once payments have been made. The HFA or the ED will review the register on a monthly basis and apply an initial as evidence of review.

6.4 Fixed Assets Register

All fixed assets acquired by ISSTA shall be recorded in the fixed asset register. All fixed assets should be engraved with ISSTA unique identification numbers, and such numbers must be recorded in the register. Staff members shall make monthly status reports of assets

entrusted to them and submit to the accountant who shall prepare a quarterly assets status report for approval by the HFA and or the ED.

The accountant shall carry out regular checks on all assets owned by ISSTA to ascertain their physical conditions, locations and sign off as evidence of review.

7.0 SALARY ADVANCES

Salary advances shall refer to advances made to staff out of their salaries before scheduled payment at the end of the calendar month. The process should be that staff begin by seeking interface with HFA who advises on filling a staff advance form kept in AAs office. The form is endorsed by the applicant and HFA. After HFA's initial endorsement, the application is directed to the office of the ED for final endorsement. ED will direct the form back to HFA for the processing of payment. HFA will ensure the updating of the staff advance register through department staff and ensure that the staff receives the advance pay. As indicated above, repayment of staff advance is done at the settlement of salaries and allowances at a rate indicated on the staff advance form. Installments should retire the advance within 3 calendar months.

7.1 Procedure for Salary Advance

- (i) Applicant seeks interface with HFA
- (ii) Applicant approaches AA for a staff advance form, fills it, and tenders it into HFA office
- (iii) HFA authorizes payment in case there exists no queries
- (iv) Application is directed to ED office for final approval
- (v) ED directs application back to HFA for processing
- (vi) When ready, the applicant is summoned to pick payment
- (vii) AA updates the staff salary advance register and other necessary registers i.e., cash book, or cheques issued register
- (viii) Applicant signs all necessary registers and vouchers pertaining to receipt of advance in cheque or cash

7.2 Advances for Programme Implementation

As discussed above, program staff will originate the advance payment 2 weeks before the activity is due through writing a one-page concept, and attaching a budget which should be

consonant with the Strategic Plan, Work Plan, and SP budget or budget line funder agreement stipulations. The program staff directs the application through the office of the PM who will verify the request. PM directs the request to HoP who verifies and if found correct, endorses for payment and sends it to HFA offices for processing of payment. HFA is expected to communicate the readiness of payment to the Programme officer (PO). PO picks the payment, signs all necessary documentation for receipt of money and departs for implementation. It has already been mentioned that PO on return from the field has to tender in accountability within a fortnight. Any unexplained shortages automatically become salary advances while surpluses are supposed to be turned in to AA for safe custody and banking.

7.3 Procedures for Accounting for Staff Imprest

- (i) The AA shall on a daily basis prepare the imprest accountability form with attached supporting documents such as invoices, receipts, signed copies of disbursements
- (ii) HFA will on a daily basis check the imprest accountability and ensure that cash at hand balances with the book balance
- (iii) AA has to update all registers and ensure that entries are posted on correct budget lines and codes
- (iv) AA is also responsible for replenishing petty cash through Accountant and FAM

8.0 BANKING

(i) Bank Accounts

Bank Accounts are the most secure and convenient custody of funds. Therefore, the organization shall operate a current account and all financial transactions shall be made by cheques as much as possible except for petty cash payments. Where it is deemed necessary to operate more than one account, a separate cash book must be maintained for each bank account. There must be sufficient justification for each account operated because it's a cost to the organization. All monies received outside petty cash must be banked at the earliest time possible

(ii) Bank Drafts and cheques – they are non-cash instruments that help to transfer bulky money but a gradually being replaced by electronic banking. However, they can be used wherever practicable

(iii) Electronic Funds Transfers (EFT)- In this case, money is transferred easily and

efficiently via the use of electronic banking and most banks have now installed electronic banking systems which involve the use of ATM machines, ATM cards some of which are VISA and Master Cards that can be used globally. Under this arrangement are other facilities like Real Time Gross Settlements (RTGS). ISSTA will employ such new innovations to suit various upcoming purposes.

No ISSTA funds shall be transferred in cash form unless there is consent by the signatories, however the above shall be done with great limitations and not exceeding UgX20,000,000.

- (iv) At each month end a statement reconciling the cash book balance to the bank statement must be prepared for each account by the accountant and verified by FAM.
- (v) The AA will act as an agent of ISSTA at the bank, in other words the primary link and responsible for coordinating all ISSTA business with banks.
- (vi) All bank accounts **MUST** have two to three authorized ISSTA signatories and under no circumstances should a cheque be signed before full details of the payee and sum payable are entered
- (vii) Bank accounts should never be overdrawn and AA should monitor bank accounts even before the routine monthly reconciliation so the issues of bouncing cheques, erroneous bank entries, and fraud do not arise since they would be checked in time. Besides being damaging to ISSTA image, issuing bouncing cheques in Uganda is a crime punishable by imprisonment. Banks also take advantage of it and pass special charges on the account
- (viii) In the event that a signatory or AA is leaving the organization, ED who is the principal signatory should write to the bank advising them of changes and ensure that the necessary requirements for the changes are affected to avoid expensive hiccups
- (ix) Safety of Cheque Books - On receipt of a new cheque book, the AA must verify that all pages are present and record it in the cheque register. In the event that a cheque leaf is missing, the matter must be brought to the attention of the signatories and the Bank without delay
- (x) The Accounts Assistant is responsible for ensuring that the cheque book is kept securely in a safe and that no leaves are stolen from it. As above it was asserted that cheques should be kept in the Account Department safe located in the HFAs office.

- (xi) Cheques must be completed clearly and in ink with no gaps left before or after words and figures that would allow later falsification of the details or value of the cheque.
- (xii) The cheque counterfoil (stub) or the space provided in the cheque book must always be completed with the following details: (a) Date, (b) Payee, (c) Brief details of reason for issue of cheque, (d) Amount in figures, (e) Signatories should sign/initial the stub/counterfoil, (f) Payment voucher number
- (xiii) The cheque information can also be filled in the first pages provided in the cheque book which should be initialed by the signatories
- (ix) After the leaves of the cheque book have been utilized the stubs must be kept safely
- (x) Cancelled cheques - In the event that a cheque is cancelled the word "cancelled" and the reason for cancellation should be written across the cheque and the stub in ink; The cancelled cheque should be perforated and stapled back into the cheque book on the corresponding cheque stub/counterfoil; The original payment request and other papers may now serve as the backing documents in the preparation of a replacement cheque; The replaced cheque stub should bear a cross – reference to the previously cancelled cheque
- (xi) Stale or lost cheques – When it becomes apparent that a cheque has been issued but remained un-cashed for a period of six months, it should be considered stale. The stale cheque should be cancelled by writing to the bank asking them to stop payment of the cheque should it be presented by any person. The stopping of the cheque should be noted in the cash book, cheque stub, and on the payment voucher and entries reversed in the cash book and noted in the outward cheques register by the AA. Effort should be made to contact the recipient of a cheque to discover why it remained un-cashed. A new payment voucher should be completed if it is appropriate to replace the cheque (Note that this expenditure should be debited to the liabilities account). The bank charge in this respect will be footed by the owner of the cheque being replaced
- (xii) Bank Statements and Reconciliation - A bank statement MUST be obtained from the bank at the end of every month for each bank account. The cash book balance should be reconciled to the balance on the bank Statement by the Accountant with oversight from HFA. The reconciliation should take into account the cheques drawn but not yet

presented at the bank and deposits made which have not yet been recorded on the bank statement. The reconciliation procedures should include investigations for all discrepancies. Documentation must be obtained from the bank to back up bank charges and any other bank items that are directly debited / credited to bank accounts. Errors on bank statement should be noted and sorted out with the bank. The reconciliation should be signed by the person preparing it and reviewed by the FAM

(xiii) Bank charges and interest - The Accountant is responsible for ensuring that the bank supplies adequate documentation to support any charges levied. The accountant has to verify calculations of bank charges, interest levied and interest received against agreed rates with the bank at account opening and any other updates communicated by the bank. These bank charges should be indicated separately and a debit advice note received from the bank that justifies the charges

9.0 ACCOUNTING RECORDS

As ISSTA chief accounting officer, the ED is responsible for ensuring the overall maintenance and proper custody of all accounting records. At no time shall accounting records leave the office premises. Normally, accounting records should be kept in soft and hard copies for five years.

The following accounting records should be maintained:

9.1 Cash Book

The Cash book must be updated daily with all money received and paid, whether by cash, cheque or bank transfer. Separate cash books should be maintained for cash and for each bank account. The cash book should be updated with information from vouchers, receipt books and bank advices. Once a month, the cash book bank ledger should be ruled off and balanced. The balance should be reconciled to the balance on the bank statement not later than the 7th day of the following month by the accountant. The HFA should verify the reconciliation and sign it off as proof of the verification.

9.2 Receipt Book

Two concurrent receipt books should be maintained to record all money received both in cash and by cheque. Pages should be sufficiently pre numbered. The receipt book should be maintained in triplicate. The original copy should be issued to the payer, duplicate copy to be attached on supporting documentation and triplicate copy should be retained in the

receipt book.

9.3 Payment Voucher

All payments will be made on a fully authorized payment voucher. The payment voucher will be initiated by AA and will be based on supporting documents availed by the staff member and or supplier seeking to be paid

9.4 Accountability Form

Retirements of advance payments will be made on the accountability form. The staff/member accounting for funds will fill in the form and attach all supporting documentation.

10.0 DEBTORS

Any person (staff or a member) who is advanced or owes money (subscription) payment to meet authorized expenses on behalf of the organization is a debtor. The amount of debt shall be decided and approved by the HFA, HoP, and ED as and when it is requested. Floats must be accounted for promptly not exceeding two weeks. No new float should be issued when there is still one outstanding unless there is a justified reason. The reason must be documented by the HFA/HoPs and consequently approved by the ED. On no account should organization money be used for unofficial purposes. If this is done then disciplinary action shall be taken against the member or staff. All accountabilities should be made on the accountability form.

11.0 CREDITORS

Creditors are those companies or individuals who have supplied or provided a service to the organization before the end of the accounting period, but where payment has not been made due unforeseen circumstances. HFA should ensure that all liabilities are recorded and settled promptly. A register should be established by AA to record suppliers' invoices when received.

12.0 PERSONNEL COSTS

12.1 Payroll procedures

Payroll calculations should be checked by the HFA and approved by the ED. Staff salaries should be paid through bank transfers or cheque and each member of staff must open up a bank account. On receipt of cheques and remittances, staff should sign for their salaries on

the payroll. A payroll documentation file should be established by the PAM to contain the following details: (a) Non statutory deductions documentation, (b) Letters of appointment, (c) Salary increment letters, (d) Contract renewal letters, (e) Pay slips should be raised and signed by the employer and the employee

12.2 Statutory deductions

Every organization employing 5 staff and above is required by law to contribute to the National Social Security Fund. In the event that the number is less by 5 the staff and employer may voluntarily apply. NSSF should be calculated and submitted to the authorities as per statute in any case not later than the 15th of the following month. PAYE must be deducted from any employee who earns any amount above 130,000/= per month. PAYE should be calculated on gross earnings of staff in the month and submitted to the authorities as per statute not later than the 15th of the following month. Local Service Tax shall be calculated and remitted on quarterly basis to the relevant government authorities. Late submission should be avoided to prevent penalties and the responsibility lies with the HFA. It shall be the responsibility of the HFA to ensure that formal communication is made to relevant statutory bodies, in case of delay.

12.3 Telephone Costs

A telephone record book shall be opened to record outgoing calls. Details will include; name of caller, number dialed, duration of call and purpose. Use of the phone for private calls should not be allowed. The phone should always be locked and keys kept by the receptionist who should report any misuse to the HFA for warnings and consequent disciplinary action.

13.0 STOCKS AND STORES

Stock represents those items that are purchased but not immediately used. They are kept in stores until they are required. Stocks are the responsibility of staff working under the HFA. All stock must be kept in secure and appropriate storage facilities with a proper system of documentation. Stores should be kept tidy in an orderly manner to ease stock counts and identification. Only required amounts of stock levels should be kept to avoid unnecessary tying up of resources. A stores register should be opened to record all the physical stock held there. All requisitions of stocks should be made on a store requisition note which should be in duplicate and must be authorized by the ED. The Accounts Assistant must not allow any

item out of the store without having an authorized Stores Requisition Note. The store requisition note should have the following details: (a) Date, (b) Name of Applicant, (c) Quantities and units of items required, (d) Description of items required, (e) Specifications of items required, (f) Authorizing signature, (g) Signature of issuing staff, (h) Signature of recipient

13.1 Good Received Note (GRN)

The GRN should be prepared in triplicate. The original copy should be given to the person delivering goods, duplicate copy to be attached to the purchase order in case of purchased items and triplicate to be retained in the booklet. The GRN should have the following details: (a) Date of receipt of goods, (b) Name of deliverer of goods, (c) Quantities, units and specifications, and (d) Signature of store keeper acknowledging receipt of goods

13.2 Material Returns Note (MRN)

The MRN should provide for the (a) Date of return, (b) Quality returned unit and specification, (c) Amount, (d) Signature of store keeper/ Accounts Assistant, (e) Reason for the return, and (f) Signature of person returning goods

13.3 Stock counting

Physical stock counts should be ensured by the HFAs department and done monthly and annually and taking stock of all items in stock. This process should take account of damaged and obsolete stock for disposal

14.0 QUOTATIONS

Three quotations should be obtained for purchases over Ugx500,000 and these should be as specific as possible to allow comparison and selection of the most appropriate. Quotations will be sought by AA and selection made by HFA, FM, and AA. For regular supplies, copies of previous quotations will be used for at least 3 months in order to optimize the time resource. Quotations below Ugx500,000 shall be processed by AA, Accountant, and HFA for onward approval of the ED. In considering a selection the following should be checked: (a) Quality of goods and services, (b) Reliability of supply, (c) Competitive and affordability of pricing, (d) Business registration certificate, (e) Any references the supplier can provide or ISSTA can identify will be useful as due diligence. (f) The ED will approve selections above Ugx1,000,000.

15.0 LOCAL PURCHASE ORDER

After the approval of quotes, the Local Purchase Order (order to supply) should be initiated by the Accounts Assistant for all purchases. For purchases above Ugx500,000. The purchase order will be prepared in triplicate with the original copy dispatched to the supplier, and duplicate copy dispatched to the store keeper while the third copy will be retained in the booklet for AA records. The purchase order should spell clearly the terms of supply and should include the following details: (a) Date, (b) Name of supplier, (c) Quantities and units of supplied, (d) Description and specifications of items (e) Terms of payment (f) Name of Person ordering, (g) Authorizing signature and (h) Duration of validity of order

16.0 SUPPLY OF GOODS

On receipt of goods, the AA, FM, FAM should check supplier's delivery against copy of purchase order. A goods received note (GRN) should be issued by the Accounts Assistant to acknowledge receipt of delivery. The GRN will be prepared in triplicate.

The duplicate copy of which will be given to supplier, while the original should be attached to the purchase order, the supplier's delivery note and suppliers invoice to back up payment. The third copy will be retained in booklet kept by the AA. Technical verification on receipt of technical purchases like computers, printers, motor vehicles, motor cycles, farm tractors, generators, and other machinery should be sought at the time of receipt of goods.

17.0 SUPPLY OF SERVICES

In case of acquisition of services like meals, accommodation, and venue for workshops, repairs with specific garages etc., quotes will be invited and after selection, documented agreements should be made and signed by both parties prior to the acquisition of services. Bills should also be verified and signed off by the HFA with support from FM and relevant programme personnel. The signing of agreements is made by the ED, HFA and HoP. In case of workshops, participants shall sign a daily attendance/participation lists. Where an agreement is signed by another cadre of staff, it should be with documented approval of the ED.

18.0 PAYMENT FOR GOODS AND SERVICES

On receipt of supplier's invoice this will be checked against the Local Purchase Order. The invoice, Local Purchase Order, suppliers' Delivery Note and the Goods Received Note will be attached together on which basis a payment voucher will be prepared by the Accounts Assistant. Payment should only be made if the invoice agrees with the actual goods received as per the GRN and any differences from the LPO or delivery note are satisfactorily explained. Advance payments to suppliers should only be made on the basis of written agreements and should NOT EXCEED 50% of the contract amount with full payments to suppliers being strictly made after delivery of goods or services.

19.0 CONFLICT OF INTEREST

No staff or BoD member shall be a supplier of ISSTA. The spouses of staff or BoD members are not eligible as suppliers of ISSTA.

20.0 USE OF ASSETS

20.1 Motorcycles

Where motorcycles are availed for official use, with the same procedures applicable for motor vehicles, they will carry a limit of passengers as specified by the manufacturer. In case of motor cycles, only one passenger should be transported at a time. Only ISSTA-staffs and BoD members are allowed as authorized riders. All riders MUST have riding permits, wear crash helmets and adhere to road safety and traffic laws. Any BoD member intending to use motorcycle will seek authorization from the ED. This arrangement has nothing to do with hierarchy but serves to promote team spirit in safeguarding ISSTA hard earned assets. Persons with bad users' records will be barred from use.

20.2 Vehicles and Insurance

ISSTA will insure all vehicles with a credible and experienced insurance company. All users will abide by the insurance policy stipulations i.e., keeping the vehicles off the road after the official working hours. Night time travel should be avoided and discouraged. All vehicles must satisfy legal and insurance requirements including the fitting of seat belts, anti - theft devices, fire extinguishers and first aid kits. The Organization shall pay third party insurance, and where finances permit, comprehensive insurance for all motor vehicles and motorcycles as

required by law. Development partners' requirements in respect of purchase vehicles should be followed.

ISSTA will insure staff and property through a selection process of the most appropriate provider. The policy should protect the organization against loss. These should include cover for fire, personal accident, travel insurance, burglary and theft, all risks, computer insurance, public liability policy, etc. HFA in consultation with ED shall be responsible for affecting all insurance policies. All purchases of assets shall be insured and a register of insured properties will be added to the register for insured properties will be kept with AA. Insurance should normally take place during the purchase of assets. HFA in consultation with ED will review the insurance cover under each policy annually.

20.2.1 Mechanical Maintenance

In order to ensure that the vehicle faults are attended to, the organization will engage the services of a competent garage with adequate stocks of spare parts. This arrangement should be reviewed from time to time to ensure value for money and efficiency in the service delivery. It is the responsibility of HFA to ensure that organization's vehicles on the road are in a roadworthy condition as spelt out in the road safety act of Uganda.

20.3 Custody of Assets

Staff member shall be directly responsible for ensuring that any Organization property entrusted to them is kept safe and in a satisfactory state. Any damage or loss must be reported to HFA immediately and the nearest police station. The ED is the chief custodian of all assets and shall ensure safe custody. ED will be assisted by the HFA in this matter. All staff should hand over motor vehicle and cycle keys every Friday evening to the AA and sign out and similarly sign in on Monday Morning for any necessary continued use particularly for designated ISSTA drivers/riders.

20.4 Asset Loss or Damage

In the event of loss or damage occurring to any item of the organization attributable to negligence or willful act of staff or BoD member, users will have to face repair or replacement costs to make good the damage or loss. If the staff member fails to pay the required amounts, the sum will be treated as an advance and deducted from their salary. If the sum is large, then such deductions will be affected in reasonable installments taking into account other deductions. In the event of death or separation of the staff concerned,

the amount owed shall be deducted from his or her terminal benefits. In case of the BoD member a commitment with the BoD should be made entailing when and how the payment be affected.

21.0 STAFF IDENTITY CARDS

All staff members will be issued with staff Identity cards for identification. Staff cards are a property of ISSTA and must be kept securely. Accounts Assistant shall maintain a register of cards issued to staff. Unused staff cards must be kept in a safe or cabinet under lock and key. Loss of staff identity cards must be reported immediately to the Police. A written statement from Police shall be required before the HFA processes and ED authorizes a reissue of staff identity card.

22.0 PER DIEMS

Per diems for both in country and outside Uganda during any financial year shall be paid according to the rates set/adjusted by HFA or HoP, with approval from the ED. Any expenditure over and above per diem limits will normally be non-refundable. Eligible individuals should complete a requisition form and show clearly the reason for overnight dates of overnight stays, authorization for overnight stay etc. Any payment to overnight per diems without proper procedure will be classified as disallowed expenditure. Per Diems will be reviewed by HFA, HoPs, and ED annually to match changing commercial and economic conditions.

22.1 BoDs SITTING ALLOWANCE

BoDs shall be entitled to a sitting allowance as required by their oversight duties. The rates of the BoDs sitting allowances will be set by HFA in consultation with the ED but will be reviewed by HFA and ED annually to match changing commercial and economic conditions.

22.2 BoD monitoring visits and other duties

BoD members on onsite visits to ISSTA activities will be paid transport refund at public rates and meals where applicable. However where a BoD member uses organizational means of transport that is motorcycle, vehicle etc, he or she shall only be entitled to meals. ISSTA will retain a list of indicative rates for transport, and meals to take care of BoDs. (see annex 9)

22.3 Out of Pocket

ISSTA shall provide out of pocket to provide for sanitary & communication and other associated cost in addition to per diem.

22.4 Accommodation

The participants should be booked into the training centers/ hotels. Invoices/receipts obtained from the training center or hotel should be used as supporting documents for accommodation. Any staff members expenses related

22.5 Transport Costs

Transport refund shall be paid at public rates basing on distance, region but within the approved budgets.

22.6 Honorarium

ISSTA staffs already receiving monthly salary / facilitation payments are not entitled to receive fees in respect of Facilitation for workshops and seminars, reappportioning, and report writing.

23.0 FINANCIAL AUDIT

The objective of an external audit is to assess the financial management of ISSTA and compile accounting statements as well as management letter. The external auditor is identified through a services procurement process by the HFA in consultation with the ED. IA will ensure a readiness of books for the audit by January 31st of every year and invite the external auditor to undertake duties. The auditor's team will closely consult with ED as the chief accounting officer, and HFAs department as implementers as they execute their duties. The external auditor, IA, ED, HFA will reach an understanding on the modus operandi, evidenced by signed contract including a workable down payment before work commences.

24.0 DISCLAIMER

No part of this document may be copied or reproduced in any form for distribution to other agencies, organizations or entities without prior written permission from the ED, except to the extent such restriction is prohibited by applicable law. ISSTA will not be liable in whatever case should anybody use this manual outside ISSTA mandate.

25.0 ANNEXES OF TEMPLATES

Please see below: 1. Sample of SCF Receipt, 2. Local Purchase Order, 3. Cash Expense Form, 4. Requisition Form, 5. Cash Requisition Form, 6. Payment Voucher, 7. Equipment Release, 8. Motorcycle Release Form, 9. Travels, Per-diem and allowance Rates, 10. Payroll, 11. Staff Salary Advance Form

ISSUA

Annex 1: Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

P.O. Box 33800

Kampala, Uganda

East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

RECEIPT

No.....

Date.....

RECEIVED from.....33800.....

The sum of shillings.....

.....

Being payment of.....

.....

By Cash/Cheque No..... Balance.....

Shs.....

Signature.....

With Thanks

For. ISSTA

Annex 2:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444
E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

P.O. Box 33800
Kampala, Uganda
East Africa

Our Ref:.....

Your Ref:

RE: LOCAL PURCHASE ORDER

No	ITEM	DESCRIPTION	QTY	AMOUNT

PREPARED BY-----SIGN-----

CHECKED BY-----SIGN-----

APPROVED BY-----SIGN-----

OFFICIAL STAMP

Annex 3:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

P.O. Box 33800

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

Cash Expenses Report

Activity

Amount Received.....

Reporting Person.....

Date	Description of Expense	Amount
Total		

Refund.....

Balance.....

Comments.....

.....

Prepared by.....**Signature**.....

Verified by.....

Signature.....

Approved by

.....**Signature**.....

Annex 4:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

P.O. Box 33800

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

REQUISITION FORM

No.

M/s _____

Please supply the following items as per quality and standard required

QTY	PARTICULARS	RATE	AMOUNT

Requested by.....

Checked by.....

Approved by.....

Annex 5:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

P.O. Box 33800

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

Date

Number.....

INTERNAL REQUISITION FORM

S/N	PARTICULARS	ACTIVITY CODE	AMOUNT

Requested by Signature

Approved by..... Signature.....

Annex 6:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

P.O. Box 33800

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

PAYMENT VOUCHER

NO.....

Date:

Dr. toA/C /CHEQUE NO.....

PARTICULARS	Amount
Total Amount in Figures	

Amount in words.....

.....

Prepared by Checked by.....

Authorized Received by.....

Annex 7:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

P.O. Box 33800

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

EQUIPMENT/TOOL RELEASE FORM

This is to acknowledge that Mr/Mrs/Ms/Miss of
..... organisation has been issued the following items:

.....
.....
.....
.....
.....

The item(s) are borrowed for the purpose of
..... to be returned
on

The responsibility for loss or damage shall be upon the borrower of the above-named organisation.

Borrower:

Name

Date

Signature

Authorised by:

Name

Date

Signature

Issued by:

Name

Date

Signature

Annex 8:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

P.O. Box 33800

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

REQUEST FOR AUTHORIZATION TO USE THE MOTORCYCLE.

I..... of (Name of the organization/Institution) request to be used the motorcycle of Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA). The purpose is to.....

I accept to take responsibility for its safety and agree to return the motorcycle by.....am/pm to the offices of ISSTA for parking. The motorcycle has been provided in good mechanical condition.

Date and time taken.....dd/mnth/yr.....hrs/am/pm

Date and time to be returned..... dd/mnth/yr.....hrs/am/pm

Signature of applicant.....

Name of the applicant.....

Title.....

Signature of the person approving.....

Approved by (Name).....

Title:.....

Annex 9:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

P.O. Box 33800

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

TRANSPORT, PERDIEMS AND ALLOWANCES

Transport

Transport shall be given at public travel rates. e.g., within the locality of Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA) office shall range from 20,000/= to 30,000 =, and transport outside locality but within the district shall range from 40,000= to 50,000= and other people shall be treated according to distance and accessibility of various locations.

Per Diem and out of Pocket

1. One night travel per Diem anywhere in Uganda.....200,000=
2. Out of pocket per day where accommodation is given.....50,000=
3. Per Diem in case of East African Countries.....500,000=
4. Rest of Africa Per Diem rates for one night.....800,000=
5. International travel Per Diem for one night.....1,000,000=

Transport costs for travel to places outside Uganda shall always be established from travel agencies.

BoD quarterly meetings

1. BoD sitting allowance 150,000/=

BoD Subcommittee Quarterly meetings

1. Sub Committee sitting allowance 100, 000/=

Annex 10:

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

P.O. Box 33800

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

**STAFF MONTHLY SALARY PAY ROLL
FOR AUGUST 2024**

S/N	NAMES	DESIGNATION	GROSS PAY	ADVANCE	PAYE	NET PAY	CHQ/ VR	EMPLOYEE SIGNATURE
001								
002								
003								

I certify that the above are true employees of Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA) and they qualify for their monthly pay as stated above.

**ACCOUNTING OFFICER
CHAIRPERSON – (ISSTA)**

or BoD TREASURER

NAME.....

SIGNATURE.....

DATE.....

Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)

Tel: +256 777725444

P.O. Box 33800

E-mail: isstaceo780@gmail.com

Kampala, Uganda, East Africa

Our Ref:

Your Ref:

STAFF ADVANCE FORM

Name Form No.

Designation Date:

Net Monthly Pay

Details	Amount (U Shs.
Outstanding advance as at	
Reason for Advance	
Total Advance	

Recovery Schedule

Month	Amount

For Official uses

Amount in words

.....

Checked by Signature

Approved by Signature

Received by Signature